

I. Front Matter (Preliminary Pages)

Component	Description
1. Title	Concise, descriptive, and informative. Should accurately reflect the content and scope of the study.
2. Author(s) Name(s)	Full names of all contributors, typically listed in order of contribution.
3. Author Affiliations	Institutional/organizational affiliations for each author.
4. ORCID ID	Optional but increasingly expected. Provides a unique identifier for each author.
5. Abstract	A concise summary (typically 150–300 words) covering: the research problem, methodology, key results, and main conclusions. Often the only section read in full , so it must stand alone.
6. Keywords	4–8 key terms or phrases that reflect the core topics, used for indexing and searchability.
7. Running Title	A shortened version of the full title (usually ≤ 50 characters) for page headers.

II. Core Body (IMRAD Structure)

8. Introduction

Sets the stage for your research. A good introduction:

- **Establishes the context** – What is the broad problem or area of study?
- **Provides background literature** – Summarizes existing work and its limitations.
- **Identifies the gap** – What is missing in the current knowledge?
- **States the research question/hypothesis** – Clearly articulates what you set out to investigate.
- **Outlines the contribution** – Why does this research matter?
- **Often includes a "Roadmap"** – Briefly previews the structure of the paper.

Common Structure: Funnel Approach – broad → narrow → specific.

9. Literature Review (Often Part of Introduction)

While sometimes integrated into the Introduction, a dedicated Literature Review:

- Synthesizes existing research.
- Identifies theoretical frameworks.
- Establishes a theoretical base for your methodology.
- Demonstrates your scholarly awareness.

10. Methodology

This section must provide **enough detail for another researcher to replicate your work**. It typically includes:

- Research Design** – Experimental, observational, survey, case study, etc.
- Participants / Sample** – Who or what was studied? How were they selected?
- Materials / Instruments** – Tools, equipment, questionnaires, software used.
- Procedure** – Step-by-step description of what was done.
- Data Analysis** – Statistical tests, algorithms, qualitative coding methods used.
- Ethical Considerations** – How were participants protected? Was approval obtained?

11. Results

Presents your findings **without interpretation** (that belongs in Discussion). This section:

- Reports the outcome of your analysis.
- Often starts with descriptive statistics (mean, median, standard deviation).
- Presents inferential statistics (p-values, confidence intervals, effect sizes).
- Uses **figures and tables** to summarize complex data.
- Follows a logical sequence, often mirroring the Methodology order.

Rule of Thumb: If it's a number, it goes here. If it's an explanation of what that number means, it goes in Discussion.

12. Discussion

Interprets your findings and explains their significance. A strong discussion:

- **Summarizes key findings** – Briefly remind the reader of the results.
- **Interprets the results** – What do these findings mean?
- **Compares with existing literature** – Do your results agree or conflict with prior work? Why?
- **Explains implications** – What do these results mean for the field, industry, or society?
- **Addresses limitations** – Acknowledges any weaknesses or constraints in the study.
- **Suggests future research** – What questions remain unanswered?

13. Conclusion

A concise final section that:

- Restates the main findings.
 - Reinforces the significance of the work.
 - Provides a final takeaway message.
 - Often stands alone for readers who skip Discussion.
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III. End Matter

14. Acknowledgments (Optional)

A section to thank:

- Funding sources (with grant numbers).
- Institutional support.
- Colleagues who provided feedback or assistance.
- Technical/administrative staff.

15. References / Bibliography

Lists all sources cited in the paper. Must follow a specific citation style (e.g., **IEEE**, **APA**, **MLA**, **Chicago**, **Vancouver**). Key rules:

- All cited works appear here.
- All works listed here must have been cited.
- Follow the journal's specific style guide.

16. Appendices / Supplementary Material

Includes information that is **too detailed** for the main text but useful for replication, such as:

- Full questionnaires/surveys.
 - Raw data or large datasets.
 - Detailed code or algorithms.
 - Additional figures or tables.
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IV. Additional Components (Varies by Discipline)

Component	Common In
Table of Contents	Theses, dissertations, long reviews
List of Figures & Tables	Theses, dissertations, long reviews
Nomenclature / Glossary	Engineering, technical fields (defines symbols & abbreviations)
Declaration / Statement of Originality	Theses, dissertations (affirms work is original)
Dedication	Theses, dissertations
Executive Summary	Industry reports, white papers (standalone summary)



Summary Table

Section	Purpose	Key Content
Title	Captures the essence of the work	Core topic, scope
Abstract	Summarizes the whole paper	Problem, method, results, conclusion
Introduction	Sets up the research problem	Context, literature, gap, hypothesis
Methodology	Describes how the research was done	Design, sample, instruments, analysis
Results	Reports findings (no interpretation)	Data, statistics, figures, tables
Discussion	Interprets findings and significance	Interpretation, comparison, limitations
Conclusion	Wraps up the paper	Restates findings, final takeaway
References	Cites sources	Full citations in required style
Appendices	Supplementary detail	Raw data, questionnaires, code



Pro Tips for Professional Writing

- Start with the Methodology and Results** – These are often the easiest to write and are based on your work.
- Write the Abstract Last** – It should reflect the final paper, not your initial plan.
- Use High-Quality Figures** – Figures should be clear, legible, and informative.
- Follow the Journal's Style Guide** – Margins, fonts, citation styles, and structure are defined by the target publication.